The strange man of Knowhere

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/72822851.

Rating:	Not Rated
Archive Warning:	No Archive Warnings Apply
Category:	M/M
Fandoms:	Marvel, Marvel Rivals (Video Game)
Relationship:	Gamora/Peter Quill
Characters:	Peter Quill, Gamora (Marvel), Thanos (Marvel), Drax the Destroyer (Marvel), Mantis (Marvel), Rocket Raccoon (Marvel), Groot (Marvel), Tony Stark, Stephen Strange, Thor (Marvel)
Additional Tags:	Peter Quill Needs a Hug, Peter Quill Feels, Hurt Peter Quill, Celestial Peter Quill, BAMF Peter Quill, Sentient Infinity Stones (Marvel), Biting, Seizures
Language:	English
Series:	Part 18 of Guardians of the Galaxy
Collections:	Anonymous
Stats:	Published: 2025-10-20 Words: 2,108 Chapters: 1/1

The strange man of Knowhere

by Anonymous

Summary

Peter is acting strange. Gamora is worried, and the Avengers are both confused and shocked.

When they reached Knowhere his instincts were screaming at him that something wasn't right. It was too quiet and he felt more on edge than usual. He noticed Gamora watching him and he ignored it. He had a feeling she'd noticed something was off about him. He wasn't sure what it was, but something inside of him had shifted recently and even though he tried to push it down and ignore it. Whatever it was wanted out and he was scared to know what that meant.

Stepping off the ship he felt a jolt of pain go through him. He ignored it and kept moving knowing how important this was and that it was probably nothing. As they moved along he'd occasionally get these jolts of pain or his mind would cloud and he swore nowhere would change. He wanted to ask the others about it when they heard Thanos' voice. It was like a switch flipped and both Gamora and Drax acted. He managed to stop Drax but not Gamora who jumped out blade going straight for his neck.

He watched in shock as Thanos was struck and blood began pouring out. Something felt horribly wrong and his body tensed. He shifted feeling as though he had ten cups of coffee with how fast his heartbeat.

One minute, Gamora was crying after killing Thanos, and then the next moment, the scene around them began to change as Thanos spoke. He gripped his weapon even as a wave of dizziness hit him. He forced himself through it, his eyes widening when Thanos appeared before Gamora. He tilted his glove, showing off his new stone, and he hunched over panting as waves of pain hit him. The Infinity Stones screamed in his ear, and he bit back a gasp, trying to be quiet.

One moment, Gamora was standing there, and the next, she was reaching for her weapon only to be grabbed by Thanos. His body shook with pain so bad that tears fell despite him trying to hold it together. He heard Drax shout in anger, and he knew things were only going to get worse. He needed to pull himself together and be stronger for his family. They were going against the most dangerous being in the galaxy and he needed to push away the pain and focus.

He watched in horror as Thanos did something that cut Drax into pieces, and then Mantis. His body shook with both pain and rage. Black spots entered his vision as he stepped out with familiar blasters in hand. He tried to be his usual self, ignoring how shaky it came out.

The pain was unbearable now, and the infinity stones were making it worse. They continued screaming at him, saying things so quickly he barely understood.

"Peter."

He ignored the look of fear and concern on Gamora's face. All his attention was on Thanos even as he spoke.

"I told you to go right."

Seeing her wrapped in Thanos's arms only made the rage inside of him intensify. He demanded that he let him go, his body shuddering as electricity ran down his spine. The infinity stones were still loudly screaming in his ear, making the pain in his body worse.

Thanos spoke, and he said something, not paying attention. He was too busy trying to stop himself from hunching over in pain.

Gamora began begging him to kill her, and even though he knew what she wanted and despite the agony he was experiencing, he still looked at her in shock.

His body froze, and he looked at her, silently begging her not to ask him that. She continued begging, and he turned his weapon towards her. Tears fell as they looked into each other's eyes. Thanos said something he didn't hear. The infinity stones went quiet, and for a moment, the pain faded as all his attention was on Gamora.

Thanos pushed her closer, and she gave him a look full of love despite the terror in her eyes. Breathing heavily, he told her he loved her and pulled the trigger. The last thing he remembered was bubbles before everything went black.

Peter had been acting weird for a while, and the others had noticed as well. She'd planned on talking to him about it, but then Thor landed on their windshield and everything happened so quickly.

Their family was forced to split up. With Rocket and Groot going with Thor. While she went to Knowhere in the hopes of stopping her father. Even though she should have been scared, all she felt was worried about Peter and his strange behavior. She tried to dismiss it as fear, but that wasn't right. Something was going on with him, and even though she wanted to ask, she knew it wasn't the time.

They landed in Knowhere, and she looked around, noticing how quiet it was. Peter was shaking not from nerves but from pain. If she hadn't heard her father's voice, she would have checked him for injuries he might have been hiding, which could explain his weird behavior.

All her attention focused on his voice, and she didn't listen to Peter instead; she jumped out ready to attack him. Her blade hit his neck, and she was shocked when she cut him. He gargled blood and collapsed dying in front of her. Even though he was a monster, she still cried because he was her father. Then the world around her changed, and it was all a lie. She should have known it was never going to be that easy.

She watched as her father appeared scared for both herself and her family. She reached for her sword, and Thanos grabbed her. She heard Drax shout, and then he was cut into pieces along with Mantis. She stared in horror, and then Peter was there. His whole body was shaking, and he looked terrible.

His skin was pale and clammy, and his face was scrunched up with pain. She never noticed the bags under his eyes that made him look as though he hadn't slept in days. She gave him a worried look despite being held by Thanos. Glancing at her father, he could tell he looked unimpressed.

Peter began speaking, and his voice was shaky and raw. As he came closer, the shaking got worse, and she could see tear tracks down from where he'd been crying. She scanned him, looking for injuries, and didn't see anything that warranted this.

As time went on, his eyes went more glassy, and he looked on the verge of collapse.

"Peter."

She desperately wanted to reach for him, but Thanos stopped her. All she could do was watch, and then she was begging. She knew Thanos had something in mind for her, and she wouldn't take part. She couldn't let him win, which is why she ignored the fear and focused on asking Peter to kill her. For the first time since he stepped out of the shadows, he looked to be listening. His eyes cleared for a second, and she told him she loved him, even as he silently begged her not to ask him to kill her.

When he pulled the triggers and bubbles came out, his whole body began thrashing. She shouted his name and turned to her father.

"What did you do to him?"

"This isn't me."

Peter suddenly stopped, and Knowhere went deathly calm. She looked over and knew it wasn't Peter. His face was all wrong and he didn't stand like that. She shivered at the look in his eyes and Thanos went to say something when he was suddenly attacked.

She stood there in shock as Thanos released her after being thrown to the floor by Peter. He tried using the stones which refused to work. He looked shocked as Peter viciously attacked him, completely oblivious to his surroundings. She looked at his face and noticed his eyes glowing slightly along with the sheer wrongness of it all. This wasn't her Peter and she didn't know what to do.

Thanos tried stopping Peter and received a snarl for his efforts and then he was biting into his neck ripping out his jugular. Thanos choked on his own blood, eyes wide and stones useless. Peter just stared down at him with a blank expression with no reaction at all to what he'd done as blood dripped down his chin.

As soon as Thanos was dead Peter stepped off and returned to his usual self if he were drunk. Looking at Drax and Mantis both of them stood up looking unharmed and shocked. Peter swayed on his feet giggling and looking confused.

"Why are we here?"

She glanced at the others, all of them looking concerned. Blood still dripped down his chin and she resisted the urge to wipe it off.

"We need to go to Earth Rocket and Groot will be waiting for us."

"Peter."

He did something with his hands which made them glow and caused the stones to disappear.

“Come on.”

He unsteadily pulled her along, determined to reach their ship even as he stumbled. His eyes were glassy as though he’d consumed an entire bottle of Asgardian liquor. She looked at Mantis hoping she could help.

“Do you know what’s wrong with him?”

“I think his powers might be coming back.”

She looked at her in alarm.”

“Ego is still alive!?”

She shook her head looking nervous.

“I don’t think Peter needs our father to use them.”

They all glanced at him as he nearly fell trying to get onto the ship. Despite the situation Drax began to laugh and Peter gave him an embarrassed look.

“Shut up.”

He climbed into the captain seat and before they could argue that there was no way he was flying like this. The ship suddenly disappeared and reappeared on what they assumed was Terra.

“Come on. They’ll be here soon.”

Peter stepped out oblivious to the shock on their faces.

“I didn’t know he could do that.”

Drax muttered and she wanted to say something but was distracted by their ship being surrounded by an army of humans.

“Who are you?”

One of them demanded pointing their weapon at him.

“I’m Peter.”

He hiccupped.

The others glanced at each other, noticing the blood still on his face.

“Are you with Thanos?”

No. He’s dead.”

Peter said that way too cheerfully.

“How?”

A few humans gave them suspicious looks wondering if this was a trap.”

“I killed him.”

Peter giggled before pausing.

“I don’t feel good.”

He gave her a sad look and then threw up. She rushed to his side along with the others.

“Peter, are you okay?”

She rubbed his back and he leaned on her looking pale. Drax steadied him in case he fell and Mantis used her powers to push away the nausea.

“He needs help.”

She pulled Peter closer looking at the humans.

“I think I can help.”

A portal suddenly appeared and a group of people stepped out.

“Tony?”

A man with a shield looked shocked.

“Steve.”

The other man said flatly.”

“Bruce.”

A girl walked over, and the man in question looked nervous before multiple people hugged him. She didn’t really care and focused on the man wearing a cape.

“What’s wrong with him?”

The man looked at the others who were listening in.

“Come with me.”

Not having another option and worried about Peter she pulled him along and followed the man ordering Drax and Mantis to follow.

The others tried to argue and Tony told them to stand down and trust Stephen.

“Boom!”

They all looked over and saw a flash of light before Thor appeared with a new axe in hand along with Rocket and Groot by his side. Peter's eyes lit up when he saw them and he rushed over.

“Rocket! Groot I missed you!”

He pulled them both into a hug and Rocket struggled.

“What’s wrong with you?”

Even though he tried looking annoyed he couldn’t hide the worry. Peter swayed and his eyes rolled back in his head. Thor had just enough time to catch him before he fell.

“Peter!”

They rushed to his side, worried about their friend. Peter had a seizure and began thrashing violently.

"Don't hold him down!"

Stephen shouted when Drax tried to stop him.

"what's happening to him?"

"I don't know exactly."

Stephen kneeled down and did something with his hands which caused Peters body to glow.

“We need to take him to the Sanctum.”

He opened a portal, and they all stepped through with Thor holding Peter after they waited for his seizure to end.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!